



Manatee County Administrative Procedures Manual

RLS Electronic Submission Procedure

Procedure #: 26-104.001

Purpose

To facilitate the submission of Requests for Legal Services (RLSs) to the County Attorney's Office (CAO) by providing County team members with clear instructions on submitting all information necessary for the CAO to deliver timely, accurate, and effective legal advice.

Procedure

To best facilitate the submission of RLSs to the CAO, County team members authorized to submit RLSs will do so by the following procedures:

1. All RLSs must be submitted to the CAO via email to: RLS@mymanatee.org.
2. The transmittal email submitting an RLS is for delivery purposes only. Do not include any facts, background, summaries, explanations, or substantive information in the body of the email. All relevant information must be included in the RLS Submission Form or in properly labeled attachments. The CAO will not review or rely upon any information contained in the email body.
3. The RLS Submission Form should be completed by the County team member, signed or initialed by the Department Director or the appropriate designee when required, and attached to the RLS submission email.
4. Confidential information or documents that cannot be transmitted electronically should be sent to the CAO via hand-delivery or interoffice mail. Please indicate the RLS subject/title, contact person, extension on the outside of the transmittal envelope. Include the RLS Number furnished by the CAO if already provided.
5. Once a new RLS is accepted by the CAO, it is assigned a sequential RLS Number (consisting of the fiscal year designator followed by a number). The submitting department will receive two emails: (1) an email acknowledging receipt of the RLS and providing its RLS Number; and (2) an email containing the names of the legal team assigned to the RLS.
6. Complete the RLS Submission Form fields as indicated below:

- a. **Subject/Title:** Brief title for the matter to be reviewed. The CAO law office management system limits the subject/title to 50 characters. The CAO may rename the subject/title consistent with best practices or to accommodate the system's character limitations.
- b. **Department/Division:** The name of the department or division submitting the request.
- c. **Account Key:** Ten or more-digit number necessary for reporting purposes by the CAO and the Financial Management Department.
- d. **Contact Person and Extension:** The name and phone extension for the County team member with the most knowledge regarding the request and who will be available to answer questions or provide additional information for the CAO.
- e. **Department Director:** The name of the director of the department submitting the request.
- f. **Signature:** The Department Director's signature is required if the request is critical or urgent. Critical or urgent requests require the CAO's immediate attention because County team members need a response from the CAO in 15 working days or less or the County will suffer some adverse result or consequence. To calculate working days, begin counting from the next day (that is not a Saturday, Sunday, or County holiday) after the date the RLS is submitted and only count days that are not Saturdays, Sundays, or County holidays.
- g. **Legal guidance on public records request:** This box should only be checked/utilized for RLSs submitted by the Public Records Department. If checked, the only other section of form which should be completed is "Copies of RLS Response to". The remainder of the form should be left blank. Public Records Department team members should attach the public records request to the RLS submission email along with this form. Any documents that need to be reviewed with this RLS should be sent to the CAO via hand-delivery or interoffice mail.
- h. **Legal question and factual background:** Description of the legal issue containing relevant facts the assigned legal team will need to understand to fully analyze the request. Background or historical information relevant to the request should be included. Include information regarding issues that may impact the request. This box is limited to 2,000 characters. If more than 2,000 characters are needed to explain the legal question and factual background, an additional page of explanation can be added to the RLS submission email and should be named "Supplemental Legal Question and Factual Background."
- i. **Services requested:** Check the box(es) for desired legal services requested from the CAO. The CAO will determine if a written response in the form of a memorandum is appropriate.

j. **Time considerations:**

- 1) **Critical/urgent/not urgent (required):** Select either critical/urgent or not urgent. Critical or urgent requests require the CAO's immediate attention because County team members need a response from the CAO in 15 working days or less or the County will suffer some adverse result or consequence. To calculate working days, begin counting from the next day (that is not a Saturday, Sunday, or County holiday) after the date the RLS is submitted and only count days that are not Saturdays, Sundays, or County holidays. The Department Director's signature is required if the request is critical or urgent.
- 2) **Date of Board meeting:** If applicable, add the date of the planned Board of County Commissioners (land use, regular or work session) or Planning Commission meeting where the RLS subject matter will be considered. If a response is needed for another type of hearing or meeting, the date and hearing or meeting type can also be added here, for example: "Hearing Officer on Month Day, Year."
- 3) **Advertising deadline:** If applicable, add the date of the first advertising deadline for the ordinance or resolution.
- 4) **Business Impact Estimate (BIE):** If a BIE is required (see Section 125.66(3), Florida Statutes), please check this box. The CAO will not be responsible for drafting the BIE but can provide a sample BIE upon request or review a draft BIE for legal sufficiency.
- 5) **Date when RLS response is needed (required):** Add the date when the CAO's response is needed. This date should take into consideration time for County team members to review, address, and otherwise act upon the CAO's legal advice, including any coordination with other parties. Notwithstanding the foregoing, the County Attorney reserves the right to establish/determine a reasonable response deadline for any RLS, based on the legal demands placed on the CAO, the complexity of the request, the volume of materials submitted, and any other relevant factors.
- 6) **Explanation of deadline requested for RLS response (required):** An explanation of why the RLS response is needed by the date requested. Please include any relevant deadlines imposed by others here.

k. **Relevant governing authorities:** Reference and provide any code provisions, laws, ordinances, policies, procedures, regulations, resolutions, rules or statutes that may be relevant or related to the RLS.

l. **List of supporting documents:** Supporting documentation should be attached as individual documents to the RLS submission email and not as a single electronic file. Do not combine documents in one PDF document. If supporting documents are not

available at the time the RLS is submitted, please indicate the reason for their omission, and when the CAO can expect to receive them. Draft documents including contracts, agreements, ordinances, and resolutions, etc., should be attached separately to the RLS submission email in Word format so they can be redlined by the CAO reviewing attorney. County team members should utilize the County's File Transfer Tool on the home page of the Employee Intranet for transmitting documents that are too large for regular email. Contact the IT Customer Service Center if you need assistance using this tool.

- m. **Related prior legal assistance from CAO and related prior RLS numbers:** If applicable, include all related RLSs or prior RLS numbers and explain any prior legal assistance on the matter given by the CAO. If a contract or agreement is being resubmitted for revisions or amendments, include the date the document was last reviewed. List the name(s) of the attorney(ies) who assisted in a previous related matter or topic.
- n. **Related prior Board action:** If applicable, add past Board meeting dates when the Board considered matters related to this RLS and related or relevant resolution and ordinance numbers.
- o. **Additional required items** (if applicable, check or complete all that apply):
 - 1) **Capital Improvement Number:** Check and include, if this RLS relates to a Capital Improvement Project.
 - 2) **Code enforcement litigation checklist:** Check and attach completed litigation checklist. Missing or incomplete checklists will result in rejection of RLS submission.
 - 3) **Flash drive provided to CAO:** Check if additional documentation was or will be provided to the CAO via hand-delivery or interoffice mail.
 - 4) **Has purchase agreement/contract been reviewed by Procurement Division?:** If this RLS involves review of a purchase agreement/contract, indicate whether it has been reviewed by Procurement.
 - 5) **If not subject to the Procurement Code, identify specific exclusion as defined by the Code:** Identify which exclusion applies to render this matter not subject to the Procurement Code, Chapter 2-26 of the County's Code of Ordinances. See Section 2-26-3 of the Code or contact the Procurement Division for guidance.
 - 6) **Name and contact information for other parties and their counsel, if represented, and/or relevant Department contact if RLS is submitted by Procurement:** Include the name(s) and telephone number(s) of other interested or opposing parties and/or their counsel. If the RLS is being submitted by

Procurement, the name and extension of the County team member with the most knowledge of the purchase agreement/contract should be included.

- p. **Copies of RLS response to:** Include the names of County team members who should receive a copy of the RLS response.

Originator, Title and Department Name

Pamela J. D'Agostino, County Attorney, Office of the County Attorney

Authorization

Charlie Bishop, County Administrator

History

Issued – 01/04/2026

Revised – 08/05/2019

Revised – 03/01/2021

Revised – 04/06/2026

Forms

RLS Submission Form

Code Enforcement Checklist

Related Directive

Manatee County Code of Ordinances Article II½.

Issued and Sunset Dates

Issue Date: 04/06/2026

Sunset Date: 04/05/2028